

JAMES AHABYONA

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EDUCATION

M.Sc. in Economics <i>Nova School of Business and Economics, Portugal</i>	2022–2024
B.A. Development Economics <i>Makerere University, Uganda</i>	2017–2021
National Diploma in Civil Engineering <i>Uganda Technical College Bushenyi</i>	2014–2016

RESEARCH AND WORK EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant <i>Yale Economic Growth Center</i>	April 2025–April 2026
Research Analyst <i>Learn More, Milan, Italy</i>	January 2024–December 2024
Research Assistant for Professor Melissa Prado <i>Nova School of Business and Economics</i>	March 2023– May 2023
Research Assistant for Professor Catia Batista <i>Nova School of Business and Economics</i>	August 2022– March 2023
Research Assistant for Professor Christopher Neilson <i>Yale University</i>	August 2021– February 2022
Enumerator <i>Policy Analysis and Development Research Institute (PADRI)</i>	June 2021–July 2021

PUBLICATIONS AND WORK IN PROGRESS

Artisanal Mines and Women Empowerment

Can Games Measure Mobile Money Adoption? Evidence from Mozambique

Child Labour in Uganda: An Annotated Bibliography

Co-author: Vanessa Cordeiro — [Download](#) — [Project Website](#)

Abstract: A comprehensive overview of child labour in Uganda, synthesizing research findings on child labour patterns, educational impacts, and intervention effectiveness. The bibliography covers work published between 2000 and 2021, with thematic indexing by region, sector, and methodology, and is intended as a reference for policymakers, practitioners, and researchers working on child-labour-related programming in East Africa.

LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCE

Founder and Editor, [The Economic Misfit](#) **Dec 2025–Present**

- Expanded the reach of The Economic Misfit to attract on average 3,000 daily visitors and more than 300,000 readers between December 2025 and March 2026 alone.
- Lead the strategic direction, partnerships, and growth of the platform through working closely with universities, research centers, and international organizations.

Co-founder, [Move Network International](#)

2019–Present

- Designed the Girl Space program where over 25 teenage mothers in my community accessed counseling, mentorship and skills development
- Secured \$1,500 grant from The Little Big Fund to empower 35 teenage mothers with entrepreneurship training and micro-grants; this project featured in [2024 Little Big Fund Impact Report](#)

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming & Software: Stata, Python, Advanced Microsoft Excel, $\text{\LaTeX}$, QGIS, Survey CTO, Qualtrics, Dedoose

Data Analysis: Data Cleaning, Data Aggregation, Data Visualization, Geospatial Analysis

Statistical Methods: OLS, Logit/Probit, Panel Data Models, Propensity Score Matching, Instrumental Variables, Difference-in-Difference, Machine Learning (Supervised/Unsupervised)

Languages: English (Fluent), Swahili (Basic), Luganda (Fluent), Ruyankore-Rukiga (Fluent), Portuguese (Basic)